

PASSWITHPURPOSE

NEW
2027
FORMAT

CAMBRIDGE IGCSE • FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH • 0500

Paper 1

Practice Pack 2

Three complete Paper 1 Reading practice papers in the new 2027 format, each with original texts, a full question paper and a detailed mark scheme.

- ◆ 3 full practice papers (240 marks)
- ◆ All four 20-mark questions
- ◆ 2-mark word-meaning questions
- ◆ Marking bands for writing
- ◆ 9 original reading texts
- ◆ New Q2(b) attitudes question
- ◆ Indicative content for every task
- ◆ Student score tracker

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For exams in 2027, 2028 and 2029. Independent practice material; not produced or endorsed by Cambridge University Press & Assessment. All texts are original.

How to use this pack

Each practice set follows the structure of the Cambridge IGCSE First Language English (0500) Paper 1 Reading exam from June 2027: three texts, four compulsory questions of 20 marks each, 80 marks in total, 2 hours.

Question	Text	Task	Marks
Q1	A	Comprehension: explicit and implicit meaning	20
Q2(a)	B	Summary, max 120 words	15
Q2(b)	B	Writer's attitudes and opinions	5
Q3	C	Short answers incl. 2-mark word meanings	10
Q3	C	Language task, 200–250 words	10
Q4	C	Extended response, 250–300 words	20

Three ways to use it

Full mock

Print the insert and question paper. Set a strict 2-hour timer. Mark with the scheme and record scores on the tracker.

Question by question

Use one question as a lesson or homework. Mark it together, then rewrite the weakest answer.

Tutoring & intervention

Diagnose with Set 4, teach the weakest skill, and use Sets 5 and 6 to measure progress.

Suggested timing (120 minutes)

Read all texts 15 min • Q1 20 min • Q2 25 min • Q3 25 min • Q4 30 min • Check 5 min. Each question is worth the same 20 marks, so don't let one question take time from the next.

BEFORE YOU MARK: The mark schemes give indicative content, not a list of the only right answers. Credit any valid point that is clearly rooted in the text.

Contents

Practice Set 4	Journeys
Practice Set 5	The Natural World
Practice Set 6	Belonging and Learning
Marking guidance	Bands for Q2(a) writing, Q3 language task and Q4
Score tracker	Record and compare results across all three sets

The Night Bus

Fiction

- 1 The bus left at ten, and by eleven Nadia had read every sign on it twice. NO SMOKING. KEEP YOUR BELONGINGS WITH YOU. EMERGENCY EXIT. She had never travelled alone before, and she found that reading was easier than thinking about why she was travelling at all.
- 2 Her grandmother was ill. That was all her mother had said on the phone, in a voice so careful that it frightened Nadia more than any detail could have.
- 3 The seat beside her was taken by an old man in a grey jacket who smelled faintly of cardamom and engine oil. He nodded to her once, folded his hands across his stomach and appeared to fall instantly asleep.
- 4 At two in the morning, somewhere in the middle of the desert, the bus shuddered, coughed and stopped.
- 5 For a moment nobody moved. Then the lights flickered off, and a groan passed through the passengers like a wave. The driver climbed down with a torch. Somewhere behind her, a baby began to wail.
- 6 The old man opened his eyes. “Fuel pump,” he said, as calmly as if he were announcing the weather. “I drove this route for thirty-one years. It’s always the fuel pump.”
- 7 He climbed down after the driver, and Nadia, not wanting to be left alone in the dark, followed.
- 8 Outside, the cold took her breath away. But when she looked up, she forgot about the cold completely. The sky was crowded with stars – not the handful she saw above the city, but thousands upon thousands of them, so thick and bright that they seemed to hang just above her head, close enough to touch.
- 9 While the two men bent over the engine, murmuring to each other in the torchlight, the passengers drifted out one by one. Someone produced a flask of tea. A student shared a packet of biscuits. The baby, carried outside by its mother, stopped crying and stared up at the sky with its mouth open.
- 10 When the old man came back, wiping his hands on a rag, he stood beside Nadia and pointed upwards. He named the stars for her, one by one, the way her grandmother used to name the plants in her garden, and Nadia realised that her fear had quietly loosened its grip.
- 11 The engine roared back into life at half past three. The passengers cheered.
- 12 They reached the city just after dawn. As she stepped down onto the pavement, the old man touched her arm. “Your grandmother,” he said. “Tell her you saw the stars.” Nadia had not told him anything about her grandmother. She turned to ask him how he knew, but he had already disappeared into the crowd.

- (e) Re-read paragraphs 2 and 5. Explain how the writer uses language to convey the overwhelming nature of the station and the kindness of the woman who helps. Select three or four powerful words or phrases from **each** paragraph and explain how they are used effectively. Write about **200 to 250 words**. [10]

Total for Question 3: [20]

Question 4 *Text C: Lost in Shinjuku*

Imagine you are the writer of Text C. A travel magazine is running a series called 'The Moment That Changed My Journey' and interviews you about your first day in Tokyo. Write the interview. [20]

In your interview you should:

- describe how you prepared for Tokyo and what you expected
- explain what happened at Shinjuku Station and how you felt
- reflect on why this moment matters to you more than the famous sights you saw.

Base your interview on what you have read in Text C, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullet points. Begin your interview appropriately. Write about **250 to 300 words**. Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

Total for Question 4: [20]